

Shane Reader, MA PhD

Policy Advisor Specializing in Health Care and Biosecurity

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Relevant Highlights

- More than 7 years of experience delivering quantitative insights in R, Stata, Tableau, and SPSS
- Direct executive and legislative policymaking experience in health care, biosecurity, and counterterrorism
- Track-record of managing critical relationships, negotiating among stakeholders, and assembling coalitions

Education

Science & Technology Policy Fellow, American Association for the Advancement of Science 2024-2026

Graduate Archer Fellow, University of Texas Archer Center in Washington DC 2023

PhD, Healthcare Management & Policy, University of Texas Health Science Center at Houston 2023

• Postgraduate Certificate in Public Health Law Research & Policy Surveillance

• Concentration in Biostatistics

MA, Experimental Psychology, Texas A&M University-Corpus Christi 2017

Select Experience

Legislative Fellow driving health care and biosecurity policy solutions in Congress and championing Virginia

United States Senate, Office of Senator Tim Kaine of Virginia 9/2025 - Present

- Drafted original legislation to solve policy problems in commercial health care, biotechnology, and biodefense
- Built persuasive coalitions of constituents, consultants, and cosponsors to advance legislation
- Briefed the Senator on critical topics including drug policy, 340B, biotech, PBM reform, and biosecurity
- Represented the Senator in meetings with 700+ advocates across 200 meetings as of April 2026
- Introduced the bipartisan *Engineering Biology Readiness Act* to build a governance framework for frontier biology
- Prepared the Senator for high-profile hearings in which he garnered national news coverage

Policy Advisor strengthening biodefense and health security as lead on policy projects (Secret clearance)

Countering Weapons of Mass Destruction (CWMD), Department of Homeland Security 8/2024 - 8/2025

- Contributed to executive orders, legislation, and White House policy products on behalf of CWMD
- Represented CWMD at the National Security Council, Office of Science and Technology Policy, and workgroups
- Developed CWMD policy positions in the context of frontier science, policy developments, and intelligence
- Authored policy documents aligning legislative authorities, executive direction, and technical capabilities
- Wrote the CWMD Environmental Biodetection Mission, scaffolding programming to detect biological threats

Health Policy Consultant advising on legislative strategy with qualitative and quantitative data analysis

Freelance (Client: Catalyst for Payment Reform) 1/2024 - 8/2024

- Delivered actionable insights in accessible presentations and reports for internal and external audiences
- Advised on coalition strategies to advance state-specific policy reforms reducing health care costs
- Reinforced client communications with original data analysis and compelling data visualizations
- Organized project tasks and timetables across work streams to execute deliverables on-budget

Doctoral Researcher producing the evidence basis for health policy and Instructor for Health Law & Policy

University of Texas Health Science Center; Texas Epidemic Public Health Institute 1/2020 - 8/2023

- Performed 50-state legal analyses and policy evaluations
- Published 6 peer-reviewed articles on health and policy, presented 6 invited talks
- Earned \$2,000+ in prize money for science and policy presentations
- Taught 481 undergraduate-level students across 5 courses and 7 individual classes
- Trained and Supervised contributing research assistants

Additional Experience

AR/VR Program Lead building 360° virtual models of patient brains and assisting with neurosurgical navigation
Surgical Theater, Inc 1/2020 - 7/2020

Contract Data Analyst evaluating population-level trends for *Harris Cares: A 2020 Vision of Health in Harris County*
Harris County Public Health 7/2019 - 11/2019

Senior Program Coordinator managing epidemiologic research into the etiology of cancer
Baylor College of Medicine, Dan L Duncan Comprehensive Cancer Center 7/2018 - 7/2019

Service

President leading a community coalition to coordinate viral hepatitis resources and advocacy
Houston Viral Hepatitis Task Force 9/2019 - 9/2021

- Founded a 501(C)(3) non-profit community-based policy coalition to fight viral hepatitis
- Implemented a two-year strategic plan informed by a community needs assessment, growing to 120+ members

Adjunct Professor of Psychology instructing students in practical applications of behavior science
Houston Community College 8/2019 - 12/2019

- Earned near-perfect student evaluations

Selected Publications

Irowa-Omoregie, D., Sanghavi, K., Reader, S.W., & Atanda, A. (*In Revision*). Temporal Patterns in Biosecurity-related Regulation Before and After Loper Bright

Reader, S.W., & Atanda, A. (2025). Loper-Proofing Next-Generation Biosecurity Policy. *Journal of Science Policy and Governance*, 26. 10.38126/JSPG260205

Reader, S.W., Breckenridge, E.D., Chan, W., Walton, G.H., & Linder, S.H. (2023). Dimension reduction of policy surveillance: Lessons from 911 Good Samaritan Laws. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence*, 249, 109934. 10.1016/j.drugalcdep.2023.109934

Reader, S.W. (2023). The Good, the Bad, and the Ugly of Good Samaritan Laws. *ATTC Messenger*. <https://attcnetwork.org/centers/attc-network-coordinating-office/attc-messenger-feature-article-march-2023>

Reader, S.W., Walton, G.H., Linder, S.H. (2022). Review and Inventory of 911 Good Samaritan Law Provisions in the United States. *International Journal of Drug Policy*, 110, 103896. 10.1016/j.drugpo.2022.103896

Reader, S.W., Kim, H., El-Serag, H.E., & Thrift, A.P. (2020). Persistent challenges in the Hepatitis C Virus care continuum for patients in a Central Texas public healthcare system. *Open Forum Infectious Diseases*, 7, ofaa322. 10.1093/ofid/ofaa322

Selected Presentations & Press

Larson, J., & Holroyd, H. (2023). Research in Practice. *Temple University Center for Public Health Law Research*. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QwMICI0kJ00>

Singer-Vine, J. (2023). Overdose-related “Good Samaritan” laws. *Data Is Plural*. <https://www.data-is-plural.com/archive/2023-01-25-edition/>

Reader, S. (2023). Dimension Reduction of Policy Surveillance: Lessons from the Nth Dimension. *Research Beyond Boundaries Poster Symposium*. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gmlOdZGnz_A

Reader, S. (2021). Modest savings following state regulation of most favored nation clauses. (\$1,000, 1st Prize). *UTHealth Virtual Research Day*. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OVdVjd8fE2M>

Ask me about my

- Award-winning science and policy presentations
- Person-centered data visualizations created with R, Stata, and Tableau, and their application to policy
- Latest baked goods: as of writing, croissant, macaron, challah, and pâte à choux